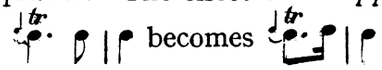
PRELUDE XIII

THE *appoggiatura* given by several authoritative MSS. in bar 1 (but not in the British Museum autograph) is a valuable contemporary check on the tendency to take this Prelude too fast. The flow should, nevertheless, be lively, and the dotted rhythms light and with plenty of spring. The three demisemiquavers after a dotted quaver are never a triplet (compare Book I., Fugue V.), the rhythm of bar 1 and of all such groups being  . The *tempo* for this piece is that in which the demisemiquavers will be very light (*louré*, as was the French expression equivalent to *effleuré*), so as to demand some humouring and broadening at the gracefully emphasised return to the main theme in the tonic at bar 57.

The first three bars (closing into the fourth) should always come forward as the main theme, so that the ensuing long flow of different material may attract notice. Not until the close in the dominant at bar 17 does the main theme receive its counter-statement. Here, in the interest of harmony, the left hand should make the phrase begin with the demisemiquavers, breaking them away from the dotted quaver as if the dot were a demisemiquaver rest. The Answer in the right hand in bar 20 should, on the contrary, be quite *legato*, treating the F♯ like the original C♯. There is no need to reproduce the *appoggiatura*, if it has been adopted in bar 1; it is of the nature of such graces that they do not make for uniformity. From bar 38 to bar 45 the detail becomes rich enough to hold back the *tempo* otherwise urged forward by the semiquaver figures, which in bar 42 delightfully rise up in humorous argument against the main theme. The four-bars tonic-and-dominant preparation for the final return (bars 53-56) may also broaden slightly in rhythm, as well as make their *crescendo* in tone.

The *appoggiaturas* are written here according to the best value for each case, instead of Bach's invariable notation of a quaver. The effect of an *appoggiatura* on a trilled dotted note is to produce a double dot—*i.e.*,  .

The alternative accidentals and readings given are not in the British Museum autograph, but in MSS. which very likely represent Bach's final decisions.

FUGUE XIII

THE Countersubject is as important as the Subject. Beginning at the last crotchet of bar 4, it at first shows nothing but a clear contrast with the Subject, and obviously requires the phrasing  . Afterwards it is shown by Episode 2 to be allied to the last figure of the Subject, which, however, remains distinguished from it by means of the ornament ∾ (here, as always in Book II., very short and bright). The shake on the first note of the Subject must always, with

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two exceptions, begin emphatically with the main note, contrary to rule, otherwise the effect of the beginning abruptly on the leading-note will be spoiled. (See also Bach's own slow written-out variation at the entry in the middle of bar 20.) In contrast to this, the final shake of the Countersubject should begin emphatically with the upper note, almost making an *appoggiatura*. The two exceptions as to the Subject occur in bars 32 and 64, where the leading-note is already prepared. The final shake of the Countersubject may be supplied wherever it is playable; and the ~ of Episode 2 should be supplied *passim ;* it sounds particularly well if neatly played in the inner part. The later Episodes are based on the first two. Episode 1 (bars 12-20) takes the quaver figure of bars 2-3 and combines it with new figures in a two-bar phrase in Triple Counterpoint. Episode 1 and Episode 3 (bars 44-52) together exhaust the six permutations of this Triple Counterpoint; a consequence of the larger fact that bars 44-68 recapitulate bars 12-36 *en bloc* a fourth higher or a fifth lower, with interchange of the upper parts, and sometimes of the bass. This being so, the interpretation of the whole is more a matter of balance than of climax. Such climax as is demanded is best attained by the rhetoric of the long quaver basses of Episode 2 and its developments, especially after the penultimate entry in bar 70, where the bass captures the initial trill of the Subject above it and mocks its written-out slower version (bar 71) before settling down to the culmination of its own devices. The upper parts, though full of life, must be carefully restrained from becoming hard or thin.

The *tempo* is that of a moderate Gavotte, such as those in the D minor English Suite and E major French Suite. (The G minor English and G major French Gavottes would be much too quick for this polyphony.)